

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

|   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|
| ♠ | - | ♠ | - |
| ♥ | - | ♥ | - |
| ♦ | - | ♦ | - |
| ♣ | - | ♣ | - |

♠ A Q 6  
♥ Q 7 3  
♦ A 8 5  
♣ K J 9 4

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ K T 9 7 5 3  
♥ 6 4  
♦ 9 7 6 4  
♣ Q

West

North  
1NTEast  
2♥South  
2♠All Pass  
2♠ by South

Baker Leben 1

[show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID 2♠]

[show NS]

This is a sign-off hand. If East hadn't bid you would either have bid 2♠, which partner would have passed, or 2♥, transferring partner to 2♠ which YOU would have passed.

With lebensohl you can do the same thing, so you bid 2♠ and partner passes.

**Board 2**

South Deals

None Vul

|     |  |     |
|-----|--|-----|
| ♠ - |  | ♠ - |
| ♥ - |  | ♥ - |
| ♦ - |  | ♦ - |
| ♣ - |  | ♣ - |

♠ K Q J 7 3

♥ 7 5

♦ 5 4 3

♣ A J 7

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ T 8 5

♥ A 8

♦ A K 7 6

♣ K Q 9 3

West

North

East

South

2♥

3♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass  
4♠ by North

Baker Leben 2

[show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID 4♠]

[show NS]

Partner's bid at the 3-level is forcing to game and shows a 5-card ♠ suit.

With 3-card support you are happy to bid 4♠.

**Board 3**

North Deals

None Vul

|     |  |     |
|-----|--|-----|
| ♠ - |  | ♠ - |
| ♥ - |  | ♥ - |
| ♦ - |  | ♦ - |
| ♣ - |  | ♣ - |

♠ A 9 6

♥ Q 7 4

♦ A 8 5

♣ A K 7 6

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ K 8 5

♥ A K J 8 6

♦ 7 2

♣ 8 4 3

West

North

East

South

1NT

2♦

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass  
4♥ by South

Baker Leben 3

[show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID 3♥]

[show NS]

With 12 points opposite partner's 15-17, this is a forcing-to-game hand, so you bid 3♥. Don't think of it as a jump, just a 3-level bid showing at least 10 points and a 5+ card suit.

Partner has 3-card support and is happy to bid game in that suit.

**Board 4**

South Deals

None Vul

|     |  |     |
|-----|--|-----|
| ♠ - |  | ♠ - |
| ♥ - |  | ♥ - |
| ♦ - |  | ♦ - |
| ♣ - |  | ♣ - |

♠ 8 6  
♥ K Q J 7 3  
♦ 5 4 3  
♣ 9 7 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ K Q 9 3  
♥ A T 8 5  
♦ A K 6  
♣ J 6

West

North

East

South

2♣

2♥

1NT

All Pass  
2♥ by North

Baker Leben 4

[\[show S\]](#)

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [\[BID pass\]](#)

[\[show NS\]](#)

Partner's bid at the 2-level is a sign-off, the equivalent of the old "drop-dead" response.

So even with your great support and maximum hand, you pass.

**Board 5**

North Deals

None Vul

|                                                                                                                                 |           |     |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-----|--|---|--|---|--|---|--|---|--|
| ♠ -                                                                                                                             | ♠ K 9     | ♠ - |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |
| ♥ -                                                                                                                             | ♥ A Q 7 6 | ♥ - |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |
| ♦ -                                                                                                                             | ♦ A K 9 2 | ♦ - |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |
| ♣ -                                                                                                                             | ♣ T 7 6   | ♣ - |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |
| <table><tr><td></td><td>N</td><td></td></tr><tr><td>W</td><td></td><td>E</td></tr><tr><td></td><td>S</td><td></td></tr></table> |           |     |  | N |  | W |  | E |  | S |  |
|                                                                                                                                 | N         |     |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |
| W                                                                                                                               |           | E   |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |
|                                                                                                                                 | S         |     |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |
|                                                                                                                                 | ♠ A Q T 8 |     |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |
|                                                                                                                                 | ♥ K J 9 5 |     |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |
|                                                                                                                                 | ♦ J 5 4   |     |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |
|                                                                                                                                 | ♣ 8 4     |     |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |   |  |

|             |       |      |       |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
| West        | North | East | South |
|             | 1NT   | 2♣   | 3♣    |
| Pass        | 3♥    | Pass | 4♥    |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♥ by North |       |      |       |

Baker Leben 5

[show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID 3♣]

With 11 points opposite partner's 15-17, this is a forcing-to-game hand, and it is possible that a jump to 3NT (which says you have no ♣ stopper) would work. However, with two 4-card Major suits you should use the lebensohl equivalent of Stayman, which is a cue-bid of 3♣.

Partner bids 3♥. What do you say? [BID 4♥]

[show NS]

With a known 8-card Major fit and a known 26-28 points you bid 4♥.

**Board 6**

South Deals

None Vul

|     |  |     |
|-----|--|-----|
| ♠ - |  | ♠ - |
| ♥ - |  | ♥ - |
| ♦ - |  | ♦ - |
| ♣ - |  | ♣ - |

♠ 7 6  
♥ K Q J 7  
♦ T 3  
♣ A T 7 3 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ K Q 9 3  
♥ A T 8 5  
♦ Q 6  
♣ K Q 6

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       |      | 1NT   |
| 2♦          | 3♦    | Pass | 3♥    |
| Pass        | 4♥    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♥ by South |       |      |       |

Baker Leben 6

[show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID 3♥]

[show NS]

Partner's direct cue-bid is the lebensohl equivalent of Stayman, but with no ♦ stopper.

With 4 cards in both Majors you bid 3♥.

Partner then bids 4♥ which you pass.

**Board 7**

North Deals

None Vul

|     |  |     |
|-----|--|-----|
| ♠ - |  | ♠ - |
| ♥ - |  | ♥ - |
| ♦ - |  | ♦ - |
| ♣ - |  | ♣ - |

♠ A 8 4  
 ♥ A Q J  
 ♦ K J 3  
 ♣ Q 7 6 3

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ 6 2  
 ♥ 8 5 3  
 ♦ Q 9 8 7 5 4  
 ♣ K 4

|      |       |      |       |
|------|-------|------|-------|
| West | North | East | South |
|      | 1NT   | 2♠   | 2NT   |
| Pass | 3♣    | Pass | 3♦    |

All Pass  
 3♦ by South

Baker Leben 7

[show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID 2NT]

With your hand you'd like to sign off in 3♦. But you cannot actually bid 3♦ because that would show a forcing-to-game hand. So you bid a lebensohl 2NT.

Partner makes the relay bid of 3♣. What do you say? [BID 3♦]

[show NS]

NOW you can bid 3♦, which partner passes.

**Board 8**

South Deals

None Vul

|     |  |     |
|-----|--|-----|
| ♠ - |  | ♠ - |
| ♥ - |  | ♥ - |
| ♦ - |  | ♦ - |
| ♣ - |  | ♣ - |

♠ 5  
 ♥ Q J 9 7 4 2  
 ♦ 9 4 3  
 ♣ J 7 4

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A 8 7  
 ♥ K 6 5  
 ♦ Q J T 6  
 ♣ K Q 6

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
| 2♠          | 2NT   |      | 1NT   |
| Pass        | 3♥    | Pass | 3♣    |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 3♥ by North |       |      |       |

Baker Leben 8

[show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID 3♣]

Partner's 2NT bid is lebensohl, asking you to bid 3♣. You bid 3♣. Partner says 3♥.

What do you say now? [BID pass]

[show NS]

How about . . . pass? Partner just signed off with this sequence. He couldn't bid 3♥ directly, that would have been a game-force.



**Board 9**

North Deals

None Vul

|     |  |     |
|-----|--|-----|
| ♠ - |  | ♠ - |
| ♥ - |  | ♥ - |
| ♦ - |  | ♦ - |
| ♣ - |  | ♣ - |

♠ 7 5 2  
♥ A K Q 6  
♦ A 3  
♣ K T 8 3

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ 8 4  
♥ 9 8 5 3  
♦ K Q J 4  
♣ A Q 7

|             |       |      |       |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
| West        | North | East | South |
|             | 1NT   | 2♠   | 3♠    |
| Pass        | 4♥    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♥ by North |       |      |       |

Baker Leben 9

[show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID 3♠]

[show NS]

With your 12 point hand you need to force to game. It would also be nice to find out if partner has a 4-card ♥ suit. So you cue-bid 3♠. This is the lebensohl version of Stayman, but WITH NO ♠ STOPPER. (Direct Denies)

Partner says 4♥ and you pass.

Board 10  
South Deals  
None Vul

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

♠ K T 5

♥ 5 2

♦ A Q J 7 3

♣ 8 7 5

♠ -

♥ -

♦ -

♣ -

N

W E

S

♠ A 9 7

♥ A J T

♦ K T 6

♣ K Q 9 4

|              |       |      |       |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
| West         | North | East | South |
|              |       |      | 1NT   |
| 2♥           | 3♦    | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |

Baker Leben 10  
[show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID 3NT]

[show NS]

Partner has promised at least a 5-card ♦ suit, and game-forcing strength. With your great ♥ stoppers you bid 3NT.

**Board 11**

North Deals

None Vul

|     |  |     |
|-----|--|-----|
| ♠ - |  | ♠ - |
| ♥ - |  | ♥ - |
| ♦ - |  | ♦ - |
| ♣ - |  | ♣ - |

♠ 7 5 2  
 ♥ A Q  
 ♦ A K 5 3  
 ♣ K T 8 3

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A Q  
 ♥ K 8 5 3  
 ♦ Q J 9 4  
 ♣ 7 6 4

|              |       |      |       |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
| West         | North | East | South |
|              | 1NT   | 2♠   | 2NT   |
| Pass         | 3♣    | Pass | 3♠    |
| Pass         | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by North |       |      |       |

Baker Leben 11

[show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID 2NT]

With your 12 point hand you need to force to game. It would also be nice to find out if partner has a 4-card ♥ suit. Since you have East's ♠ suit stopped, you first bid a lebensohl 2NT.

Partner says 3♣. What do you bid? [BID pass]

[show NS]

NOW you cue-bid 3♠. This is Stayman, but with a ♠ stopper, (SLOW SHOWS). Partner says 3NT and you pass.

**Board 12**  
 South Deals  
 None Vul

|     |  |     |
|-----|--|-----|
| ♠ - |  | ♠ - |
| ♥ - |  | ♥ - |
| ♦ - |  | ♦ - |
| ♣ - |  | ♣ - |

♠ J 9 6 4  
 ♥ K Q 7 3  
 ♦ A Q 9  
 ♣ T 3

N  
 W     E  
 S

♠ K Q 8  
 ♥ A J 5  
 ♦ T 6  
 ♣ K Q J 9 4

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 1NT   |
| 2♦           | 2NT   | Pass | 3♣    |
| Pass         | 3♦    | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |

With no 4-card Major of your own, you pick 3NT.

Baker Leben 12  
 [show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID 3♣]

Partner's 2NT bid requests that you bid 3♣, so you do.

He next says 3♦. What do you bid now? [BID 3NT]

[show NS]

Partner has just described a hand with which he wants to play in game, which has at least one 4-card Major suit, and has ♦s stopped. He wants you to pick the game.

**Board 13**

North Deals

None Vul

|     |  |     |
|-----|--|-----|
| ♠ - |  | ♠ - |
| ♥ - |  | ♥ - |
| ♦ - |  | ♦ - |
| ♣ - |  | ♣ - |

♠ K 9 5  
♥ A J 9  
♦ K Q 8 5  
♣ A T 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A 7 4  
♥ 7 6 3  
♦ A J 6  
♣ K 9 7 4

|      |       |      |       |
|------|-------|------|-------|
| West | North | East | South |
|      | 1NT   | 2♥   | 3NT   |

All Pass  
3NT by North

Baker Leben 13

[show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID 3NT]

[show NS]

With 12 points opposite partner's 15-17, this is a forcing-to-game hand. If it had not been for the ♥ overcall you would just have jumped to 3NT.

Playing lebensohl you do the same thing, jump to 3NT. Since you went directly to 3NT you are telling partner you have that type of hand, but DO NOT have a ♥ stopper (DIRECT DENIES).

Partner does have them stopped so he passes.

**Board 14**

South Deals

None Vul

|     |                                                       |     |
|-----|-------------------------------------------------------|-----|
| ♠ - | ♠ Q T 4                                               | ♠ - |
| ♥ - | ♥ K J 6                                               | ♥ - |
| ♦ - | ♦ A 9 7                                               | ♦ - |
| ♣ - | ♣ K T 8 3                                             | ♣ - |
|     | <div> <div>N</div> <div>W E</div> <div>S</div> </div> |     |
|     | ♠ A J 5                                               |     |
|     | ♥ 9 7                                                 |     |
|     | ♦ K Q T 8 3                                           |     |
|     | ♣ A Q 7                                               |     |

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 1NT   |
| 2♥           | 2NT   | Pass | 3♣    |
| Pass         | 3NT   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 3NT by South |       |      |       |

Baker Leben 14

[show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID 3♣]

Partner's 2NT bid requests that you bid 3♣, so you do.

He next says 3NT. What do you bid now? [BID pass]

[show NS]

Partner's bidding shows a hand with which he would have bid 3NT without the overcall. Furthermore, he promises a ♥ stopper. He expects you to pass, so you do.

**Board 15**  
 North Deals  
 None Vul

|     |  |     |
|-----|--|-----|
| ♠ - |  | ♠ - |
| ♥ - |  | ♥ - |
| ♦ - |  | ♦ - |
| ♣ - |  | ♣ - |

♠ 7 4 2  
 ♥ A Q  
 ♦ A K 5 3  
 ♣ K T 9 3

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A Q 5  
 ♥ K 8 3  
 ♦ Q J 9 4  
 ♣ 7 6 4

|                          |       |      |       |
|--------------------------|-------|------|-------|
| West                     | North | East | South |
|                          | 1NT   | 2♠   | 2NT   |
| Pass                     | 3♣    | Pass | 3NT   |
| All Pass<br>3NT by North |       |      |       |

Baker Leben 15  
 [show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID 2NT]

With your 12 point balanced hand you know you are going to play in game. Since you have no interest in looking for a 4-4 Major suit fit you also know that game is going to be 3NT. But you can't actually BID 3NT, because partner would almost surely take you out to a minor suit. Remember, a DIRECT 3NT bid DENIES a stopper in their suit. Since you have East's ♠ suit stopped, you first bid a lebensohl 2NT.

Partner says 3♣. What do you bid? [BID 3NT]

[show NS]

You now complete the picture of your hand by bidding 3NT. (SLOW SHOWS). Partner passes.

**Board 16**

South Deals

None Vul

|     |  |     |
|-----|--|-----|
| ♠ - |  | ♠ - |
| ♥ - |  | ♥ - |
| ♦ - |  | ♦ - |
| ♣ - |  | ♣ - |

♠ K J 7 3

♥ 9 6 4

♦ J 8 2

♣ K 6 5

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ T 8 5

♥ A K 7

♦ K Q 7 3

♣ A 7 4

West

North

East

South

2♠

Dbl

1NT

All Pass

2♠X by West

Baker Leben 16

[\[show S\]](#)

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [\[BID pass\]](#)

[\[show NS\]](#)

Playing lebensohl, when partner doubles the overcall it is for penalties.

Since you trust your partner, you pass.



**Board 17**

North Deals

None Vul

|     |  |     |
|-----|--|-----|
| ♠ - |  | ♠ - |
| ♥ - |  | ♥ - |
| ♦ - |  | ♦ - |
| ♣ - |  | ♣ - |

♠ K J 5  
 ♥ K J 7  
 ♦ A 9 6  
 ♣ K Q T 2

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ Q 7 4  
 ♥ Q T 9 6 5  
 ♦ 8 3  
 ♣ A 8 3

|                         |       |      |       |
|-------------------------|-------|------|-------|
| West                    | North | East | South |
|                         | 1NT   | 2♦   | 2NT   |
| Pass                    | 3♣    | Pass | 3♥    |
| Pass                    | 4♥    |      |       |
| All Pass<br>4♥ by South |       |      |       |

have a 5-card suit, so he bids 4♥.

Baker Leben 17

[show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID 2NT]

With 9 points you don't want to sign-off with 2♥. But you aren't strong enough to force to game with a 3♥ bid either. So you start an invitational sequence by bidding 2NT.

Partner says 3♣. What do you bid? [BID 3♥]

[show NS]

Now you bid 3♥. Partner will realize you have better than a sign-off, but were not good enough to bid 3♥ immediately. He has a maximum, and he knows you

**Board 18**

South Deals

None Vul

|     |  |     |
|-----|--|-----|
| ♠ - |  | ♠ - |
| ♥ - |  | ♥ - |
| ♦ - |  | ♦ - |
| ♣ - |  | ♣ - |

♠ A J 6 3

♥ 9 4

♦ A 8 5

♣ K J T 3

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ K Q 5

♥ T 8

♦ K Q 7 3

♣ A Q 7 4

West

North

East

South

2♥

3♥

Pass

4♣

Pass

5♣

All Pass  
5♣ by South

Baker Leben 18

[show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID 4♣]

[show NS]

Partner's bid asks if you have 4 ♠s, and denies a ♥ stopper. (DIRECT DENIES)

You don't have 4 ♠s, nor can you stop ♥s. You have no choice but to bid one of the 4-card Minor suits, so you go up-the-line and bid 4♣. Partner bids 5♣.

**Board 19**

North Deals

None Vul

|     |  |     |
|-----|--|-----|
| ♠ - |  | ♠ - |
| ♥ - |  | ♥ - |
| ♦ - |  | ♦ - |
| ♣ - |  | ♣ - |

♠ K 7 3  
♥ A 9 5 2  
♦ Q 5  
♣ A K J 5

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ A 8  
♥ 7 6 4  
♦ A J 9 7  
♣ T 9 6 4

|      |       |      |       |
|------|-------|------|-------|
| West | North | East | South |
|      | 1NT   | 2♦   | Dbl   |

All Pass  
2♦ X by East

Baker Leben 19

[show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID double]

[show NS]

It is possible your side can make 3NT on this deal. You have 9 points, invitational strength, and your ♦ stopper is excellent.

However you should look for an even bigger reward by doubling. East is in serious trouble, and when the opponents make a mistake you should punish them.

**Board 20**  
 South Deals  
 None Vul

|     |  |     |
|-----|--|-----|
| ♠ - |  | ♠ - |
| ♥ - |  | ♥ - |
| ♦ - |  | ♦ - |
| ♣ - |  | ♣ - |

♠ Q T 8 4  
 ♥ K 6  
 ♦ A T 7  
 ♣ K T 8 3

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ K J 9 3  
 ♥ A Q 8 7  
 ♦ 9 5  
 ♣ A Q 7

| West                    | North | East | South |
|-------------------------|-------|------|-------|
|                         |       |      | 1NT   |
| 2♦                      | 2NT   | Pass | 3♣    |
| Pass                    | 3♦    | Pass | 3♥    |
| Pass                    | 3NT   | Pass | 4♠    |
| All Pass<br>4♠ by South |       |      |       |

Baker Leben 20  
 [show S]

The bidding has gone as shown. Decide what you would say, then click on BID above. [BID 3♣]

Partner's 2NT bid requests that you bid 3♣, so you do. He next says 3♦. What do you bid now? [BID 3♥]

Partner's bid is game-forcing Stayman, but with a ♦ stopper (SLOW SHOWS). Holding 4 cards in each Major you bid up-the-line, 4♥. Partner now bids 3NT. What do you say? [BID 4♠]

[show NS]

Partner would not have asked for a 4-card Major unless he held one himself. Since it wasn't ♥s it must be the other one. You bid 4♠.